

NAPOLEON AT WAR

Marengo

Napoleon in Italy, 14 June 1800

Exclusive Rules

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[12.0] INTRODUCTION

Marengo is an operational level simulation of the battle between Napoleon's French Army and the Austrian Army commanded by General von Melas, which occurred on June 14, 1800 in Piedmont (northern Italy). One of Napoleon's first important victories, the battle was decided by the opportune arrival of French reinforcements who robbed Melas of the triumph he had almost achieved earlier in the day. For the rest of his career, on many more famous battlefields, Napoleon often exhorted his troops with the mention of the glorious French victory of Marengo.

[13.0] INITIAL DEPLOYMENT CHART

On the Initial Deployment and Reinforcement Charts, an "a" following the unit's Strength-Type means the unit is artillery; a "c" means cavalry; all other unspecified units are infantry.

[13.1] FRENCH ARMY

Hex	Strength -Type	Designation
1111	4-4	44
1110	2-4	101
1312	5-5	24
1412	5-4	43
1411	4-4	96
2310	4-5	69
2311	2-4	28
2409	3-4	22
2410	4-4	40
1808	2-6c	Champeux (Cham)
1215	2-7c	Kellerman (Kell)
1115	2-6c	DuVigneau (DuVi)
2211	2-4a	Advanced Guard (AvGd)
1513	2-4a	Victor (Vict)
2715	2-4a	Reserve (Res)
3213	2-7c	Guard (Gd)

[13.2] AUSTRIAN ARMY

Hex	Strength -Type	Designation
0608	6-3	Rousseau (Rous)
0708	3-5	Frimont (Frim)
0508	3-3	Bellegarde (Bell)
0507	5-3	St. Julien (StJu)
0406	5-3	Kneswich (Knes)
0407	2-3	Lamarsaille (Lama)
0408	4-3	De Berry (DeBe)
0308	7-3	Latterman (Latt)
0307	7-3	Weiednfield (Weie)
0404	2-3	Gottersheimer (Gott)
0206	4-3	Sticker (Stic)
0105	4-3	Retz
0106	5-3	Ulm
0906	1-3	Pioneers (Pion)
0509	2-5c	O'Reilly (ORei)
0607	1-5c	Advanced Guard (AvGd)
0606	4-7c	Pilati (Pila)
0506	4-5c	Nobli (Nobl)
0505	5-5c	Nimpitsch (Nimp)
0405	1-5c	Vogelsburg (Voge)
0207	1-5c	Schellenburg (Sche)
0707	2-3a	Advanced Guard (AvGd)
0309	3-3a	Main Body (Main)
0205	4-3a	Left Column (LCol)
0305	3-3a	Right Column (RCol)

[13.3] PLAYER SEQUENCE

[13.31] The Austrian Player is the first Player. His Player-Turn is first in each Game-Turn.

[13.32] The Game Length is fourteen Game-Turns.

[14.0] REINFORCEMENTS

GENERAL RULE:

The French Player receives reinforcements according to the Reinforcement Chart. These units are placed on the edge of the map in the hex indicated. Reinforcing units arrive during the French Player's Movement Phase of the Game-Turn indicated.

[14.1] The French Player may enter his reinforcement units onto the map at any time during his Movement Phase.

[14.2] Once a unit has entered the map, it may move and engage in combat freely, just as any other unit already present.

[14.3] Each reinforcing unit expends one Movement Point to be placed on the entry hex. Units may exceed the stacking restrictions when entering the map in the same hex, as long as they conform to stacking restrictions by the end of the Movement Phase.

[14.4] Units forced off the map by combat are considered eliminated for Victory Conditions.

[14.5] There are no Austrian reinforcements.

[14.6] FRENCH REINFORCEMENT CHART

Reinforcements may enter the map in Enemy controlled hexes. They may not enter the map if their specified entry hex is occupied by any unit. Instead, they are delayed until the hexes are vacant.

Strength

-Type Designation

Arriving on Game-Turn Two on hex 3912:

3-4 Consular Guard (CnGd)

Arriving on Game-Turn Four on hex 3912:

4-5 19

3-4 70

4-4 72

Arriving on Game-Turn Five on hex 3912:

2-4a DeSaix (DeSa)

Arriving on Game-Turn Six on hex 3925:

5-5 9

2-4 30

4-4 59

Arriving on Game-Turn Eight on hex 2401:

2-7c Murat (Mura)

on hex 2501:

1-7c DuMoulin (DuMo)

on hex 2301:

2-6a Cavalry (Cav)

Arriving on Game-Turn Nine on hex 3301:

2-6c Rivaud (Riva)

[14.7] GAME LENGTH

Marengo consists of 14 Game-Turns. All are Day Game-Turns.

[15.0] SPECIAL RULES

[15.1] SPECIAL FRENCH FIRST GAME-TURN RESTRICTIONS

For the First Game-Turn (only), all French units have their Movement Allowance halved. In addition, French units are prohibited from entering Austrian Zones of Control during the French Movement Phase of the First Game-Turn.

[15.2] SPECIAL FRENCH COUNTERATTACK RULE

At the beginning of the French Combat Phase on Game-Turn Nine or any subsequent Game-Turn, the French Player may initiate his counterattack by announcing it to the Austrian Player. All French units have their Combat Strength doubled for three consecutive French Combat Phases, which immediately follow the French Player's announcement. Example: The French Player announces his counterattack at the start of the French Combat Phase on Game-Turn Ten. All French units would have their Combat Strength doubled during the French Combat Phase on Game-Turns Ten, Eleven and Twelve (only). Note that the French units use their normal (printed) Strength for defensive purposes during the Austrian Combat Phases of these three Game-Turns.

[16.0] VICTORY CONDITIONS

GENERAL RULE:

At the end of the Fourteenth Game-Turn, play ceases and the victor is determined according to the criteria given in the following cases.

CASES:

[16.1] The game is considered a French victory if the French Player has eliminated at least 33 Austrian Combat Strength Points and there are a minimum of 10 French Combat Strength Points within four hexes of Marengo (hex 1412) at the end of the game.

[16.2] The game is considered an Austrian victory if the Austrian Player has eliminated at least 30 French Combat Strength Points and both Marengo (hex 1412) and Pietrabuona (hex 1111) are occupied by Austrian units at the end of the game.

[16.3] If neither Player eliminates the required number of Enemy Combat Strength Points, victory is awarded to the Player who has satisfied his geographical objectives.

[16.4] If both Players satisfy their geographical objectives, the game is automatically considered a draw and no consideration is given to the elimination of Combat Strength Points.

[17.0] DESIGNER'S NOTES

Marengo was intended from the outset to be a simple game. Of all the four games in the **Napoleon at War** series, it probably lent itself more towards the **Napoleon at Waterloo/Borodino** system than any of the others. It was also a simple, clean situation with a small number of units. A small number of units is good in one way, as it makes for a short, quick game, but it is bad in that it places more emphasis on a few important die rolls. "Luck" is more important in **Marengo** than in many other games. But the sides are equally balanced, and between equal Players neither has the advantage in this game.

The two Special Rules in **Marengo** were dictated by the historical circumstances. The Austrians did catch the French napping, and that is why the French movement and attack capacity is reduced on Turn One. Similarly, Bonaparte launched a counterattack near the close of the day, made more effective by the fact that the Austrians were tired and their commanders were confident success had been achieved — General Melas had already retired from the field to write his victory despatch when the blow fell. All of this has been incorporated into the French counterattack.

The actual battle came as Napoleon Bonaparte pursued the Austrian field army under General Melas to the fortress of Alessandria during the 1800 campaign in Italy. General Napoleon Bonaparte, First Consul of France and budding dictator, brought his Army of the Reserve to besiege the city and keep Melas moving. At that time, the French moved quicker than the Austrians. Although the Austrians had "invented" light infantry tactics during the Seven Year's War, the French adopted their use on a wide scale. This tactical difference gave the French additional advantages incorporated in the game.

The Austrians, rather than running, made a surprise attack on the morning of June 14. At first, Bonaparte thought it was just a probe, but at 9:30, an hour and a half after the attack opened, the French had been forced back from Pietrabuona to Marengo. By 10:00, the French were holding a line around Marengo as the Austrians tried to attack

down the road. The Austrians continued to attack at Marengo while French reinforcements came up. By 1400, they had extended their left flank enough to overstretch the French positions. The fifth Austrian attack on Marengo turned the French out of the town. Bonaparte ordered a retreat to the large hill in the center. Melas, convinced the day was his, retired to write his victory despatch while his tired troops stumbled forward. By 1700, the Austrians had engaged the French on the top of the large hill. Just as they were beginning to force the French line back, Bonaparte unleashed the cavalry reserve he had formed in a devastating counterattack that changed the outcome of the battle. The Austrians were soon swept back as the French line advanced. By 2200, they had been pushed back to the original bridgehead. The French lost over 6,000 out of 28,500, the Austrians, 9,402 of 33,800. It was "a near run thing" that required all of Bonaparte's skill to recover from the initial blow. We hope to have duplicated this fascinating and versatile situation in the **Marengo** game.

[18.0] PLAYER'S NOTES

Marengo is a simple game, but the tactics required by the situation are anything but simple. Both Players must, to have a chance at victory, be adept at both offensive and defensive tactics, while keeping their ultimate objective always in view.

The Austrian Player has the burden of the initial attack placed squarely on him. His advance is nothing if not constricted. He is hemmed in by the moat of Alessandria and the small number of bridges, not to mention the rough terrain on the flanks. Thus, the Austrian must get out of this bottleneck and into the open across the river as soon as possible.

Once across the river, the Austrian must divide into two thrusts. The basic tendency is to drive down the road to Marengo, but the Austrian must also send forces off to the flank, otherwise he will be corked up by French resistance. In the first Turns, the longer the Austrian can make his lines, the harder it will be for the French to cover everything. If the French line can be stretched (and weak cavalry units are excellent for grabbing weak flanks as well as semi-suicidal diversionary attacks), it can probably be ruptured by the more powerful units supported by the artillery. The Austrian should use both bridges to advance, and should not be afraid of putting his weight onto a stroke north of Marengo. If Marengo and Pietrabuona fall early, the Austrian should try and push the French back as far as possible, ideally to the large ridge in the center, and not let the French regroup for a counterattack. Keep the pressure on, or he will chew you up with the counterattack. Watch for cavalry slipping behind you, especially at this juncture.

One tactic, which both French and Austrian can profit by, is to sequence your attacks so as to surround a vital position, if not with units, then with Zones of Control, cutting off enemy retreat routes. Both Players should always surround the enemy wherever possible. Cavalry units are often able to get around to cut retreat routes, while artillery is especially valuable for diversionary attack.

The French Player must play a subtle defense. If he fights too far forward he will be engaged, surrounded, and put in the sack by the Austrians, who will then mop up the reinforcements a few at a time. The French must maintain their mobility and should only get involved in a slugging match early in the game if they can tie down and bottle-

neck a sizable number of Austrian units. The French should not be afraid of withdrawing, even if this means abandoning engaged units. The large hill in the center with its surrounding villages is an excellent defensive position if you have enough units to keep a cohesive line. The French counterattack must be effective to win. Again, the French must put emphasis on operations on the flanks, as a drive up the road to Marengo will often be bottlenecked and slow down to a crawl. One should wait for the right moment to launch the counterattack, and go at the Austrians full force. If you have kept up a good defense earlier and inflicted loss on the Austrians, victory will be within reach.

The Combat Results Table for **Marengo** is essentially of a "surround" nature; that is, it is relatively bloodless and uncertain even at higher odds columns. Consequently, most units, particularly the larger ones, will be eliminated by being unable to retreat rather than as a direct result of combat. For this reason, the Players must sequence their attacks and advances after combat for the express purpose of trapping Enemy units and forcing them to retreat when they have nowhere to go. However, this must be done carefully, lest the advancing units become surrounded themselves if a subsequent attack fails. Combat odds should always be voluntarily reduced to 4 to 1 when attacking units which are surrounded, since this ensures their destruction and minimizes the chances of an exchange.

One other effect of this system of advance and retreat is that it encourages the use of "island" rather than "line" tactics. In other words, it is often better to alternate Friendly occupied hexes with vacant ones rather than have a completely solid line of units. That way the front can be held by a minimum number of units without any danger of being surrounded when adjacent Friendly units retreat. Of course, this is not always possible or even desirable, since it does allow the enemy to achieve greater concentration in his attacks.

Artillery should be used for low odds diversionary attacks (which allow a concentration of strength against other specific units), and to achieve the best possible combat odds. By the way, you may want to reduce diversionary attacks made solely by bombarding artillery to the lowest possible combat odds to avoid your "winning" the attack and forcing the Enemy unit to retreat out of a Friendly Zone of Control. Terrain should also be taken advantage of; particularly the doubling effect of ridge hexsides.

ORDER OF BATTLE

L'ARMEE DE RESERVE [BONAPARTE]

Corps (De Saix)

Division (Gardanne): (44th, 101st demi-brigades), Corps Artillery.

Advanced Guard (Lannes)

Division (Chambarlhac): (24th leger, 43rd, 96th demi-brigades), Corps Artillery.

Corps (Victor)

Division (Monnier): (19th leger, 70th, 72nd demi-brigades)
Division (Boudet): (9th leger, 30th, 59th demi-brigades)
Division (Watrin): 69th leger, 28th, 22nd, 40th demi-brigades).

Consular Guard: (infantry, cavalry regiments), Corps Artillery.

Cavalry Reserve

Brigades: Murat, Champeux, Kellerman, Du Vigneau, Dumoulin, Rivaud; Horse Artillery.

Artillery Reserve

AUSTRIAN ARMY [MELAS]

Right Column

Division (O'Reilly): Rousseau, brigade; O'Reilly, (cavalry) brigades.

Advanced Guard Division: Frimont, cavalry brigades, Attached Artillery.

Main Body

Division (Haddick): Bellegarde, St. Julien, Pilati (hussar) brigades.

Division (Kain): Knesewich, La Marsaille, De Berey brigades.

Division (Morzin): Latterman, Weidenfeld Grenadier Brigades, Pioneer.

Division Elsnitz (cavalry): Nobli, Nimpisch brigades.

Left Column

Division (Schellenburg): Gottesheim, Retz, Sticker, Ulm brigades; Vogelsgang, Schellenburg brigades (cavalry); Attached Artillery.

DESIGN CREDITS

Game Design: **David C. Isby**

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Redmond A. Simonsen

Systems Design and Game Development:
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[7.6] COMBAT RESULTS TABLE

Die Roll	Probability Ratios (Odds) Attacker's Strength to Defender's Strength										Die Roll
	1-5	1-4	1-3	1-2	1-1	2-1	3-1	4-1	5-1	6-1	
1	Ar	Ar	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	De	De	De	1
2	Ar	Ar	Ar	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	De	De	2
3	Ae	Ar	Ar	Ar	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	De	3
4	Ae	Ar	Ar	Ar	Ar	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	Dr	4
5	Ae	Ae	Ar	Ar	Ar	Ar	Dr	Dr	Ex	Ex	5
6	Ae	Ae	Ae	Ar	Ar	Ar	Ar	Ex	Ex	Ex	6

Attacks executed at greater than 6-1 are treated as 6-1; attacks executed at worse than 1-5 are treated as 1-5.

EXPLANATION OF COMBAT RESULTS

Ae = Attacker Eliminated. All Attacking units are eliminated (removed from the map).

De = Defender Eliminated. All Defending units are eliminated.

Ex = Exchange. All **Defending** units are eliminated. The Attacking Player must eliminate **Attacking** units whose total, printed (face value) Combat Strengths **at least** equal the total printed Combat Strengths of the eliminated Defending units. Only units which participated in a particular attack may be so eliminated.

Ar = Attacker Retreat. All Attacking units must retreat one hex (see 7.7).

Dr = Defender Retreat. All Defending units must retreat one hex.

[9.0] TERRAIN EFFECTS CHART

(See Terrain Key on Map)

Terrain	Movement Points [MP] to Enter [or Cross]	Effect on Combat
Clear Hex	1 MP	No effect
Forest Hex	2 MP	No Effect (See 8.3)
Rough Hex (Battle of Nations, Marengo only)	2 MP	Defender doubled in hex
Slope Hexside (Wagram, Marengo, Jena-Auerstadt only)	1 MP additional to cross moving from Slope hex	Defender doubled when attacked exclusively through Slope hexsides from Slope hexes
Road Hex	½ MP if entered through road hexside	Depends on other terrain
Trail Hex (Marengo only)	1 MP if entered through Trail hexside	Depends on other terrain
Marsh Hex (Battle of Nations only)	Entry prohibited except through road	Defender doubled in hex
Town Hex	1 MP	defender doubled in hex (See 8.3)
River Hexside	May only cross at bridges	May only attack across bridges
Stream Hexside	2 MP additional to cross	Defender doubled when attacked exclusively through Stream hexsides
Bridge Hexside	No additional MP	Defender doubled when attacked exclusively through Bridge hexside(s)

Note: Terrain Effects are cumulative for Movement purposes, but not for Combat purposes. Thus, to enter a Rough hex through a Stream hexside costs four Movement Points. A unit in a Rough hex which is attacked through a Stream hexside is merely doubled, not quadrupled.